

LAKE ILLAWONG RESIDENTIAL VILLAGE

Board of Management

Complaints and Disputes

Board and Operator Guide

Version 1.2 — July 2026

**CONFIDENTIAL — BOARD AND OPERATOR GUIDE. NOT FOR
DISTRIBUTION TO RESIDENTS.**

This is the Board and Operator Guide to the Lake Illawong Complaints and Disputes Policy. It sets out the legislative obligations, operational procedures, and Management System guidance for Board members administering complaints and disputes. The resident-facing procedure — how to raise a complaint or dispute and what to expect — is published separately as the Complaints and Disputes — Resident Guide.

1. Legislative Framework

This procedure is made under the Retirement Villages Act 2024 (Vic) (the Act), effective 1 May 2026. The Act imposes mandatory obligations on the Operator. Key obligations are:

Obligation	Timeframe / Requirement
Establish and maintain a written complaints/dispute procedure and make it accessible to all residents.	Ongoing. The Board is to determine and confirm the appropriate mechanism for meeting this requirement. See Document Control, Section 11.

Provide a copy of this policy to any resident who requests one.	Within 2 business days of request.
On receipt of a complaint or dispute notice, create a formal electronic record.	As soon as practicable.
Acknowledge the complaint.	Within 2 business days of receipt.
If not resolved within 72 hours, record a written action plan (reasons unresolved, actions to be taken).	Within 72 hours of receipt.
Provide a formal written response.	Within 28 days of receipt.
Refer an unresolved dispute to VicAssist.	If not resolved within 28 days of notice.
Retain all records.	Minimum 7 years.
Nominate a Primary and Alternative Contact Person.	Ongoing. Alternative must hold a senior position; must not be a relative or friend of the Primary.
Present a dispute report at each annual meeting and provide a copy to the Director of Consumer Affairs Victoria.	Within 14 days of annual meeting, via myCAV.

2. Management System

All complaints and disputes are managed through the Lake Illawong Management Central System (the Management System). The system is maintained by the village's system administration. The Board accesses complaints and disputes through the Admin Portal using role-based identity verification.

Reference number formats:

- Complaints: COMP-YYYYMMDD-NNN — e.g. COMP-20260615-001
- Disputes: DISP-YYYYMMDD-NNN — e.g. DISP-20260615-001

Automated notifications are sent from irc.mtceteam@gmail.com. This address does not accept replies. A full notification reference is in Appendix A.

3. Complaints — Operator Procedure

3.1 Receipt

Complaints reach the system in one of two ways. Residents may submit directly via the Resident Portal (OTP-verified); the record is created

automatically. For complaints received verbally, by email, or in writing, the Board lodges the complaint on the resident's behalf using the Proxy Complaint Submission module in the Admin Portal, entering the same details (category, description, etc.) the resident would otherwise provide — the Proxy form has no declaration field, since the declaration is a resident self-certification that does not apply to a Board-lodged complaint. The Complaints Manager itself has no function for manually creating a new record — Proxy Complaint Submission is the only path for non-electronic lodgement. In both cases the system sends lodgement notifications to the resident and an internal alert to the Board, RC, and Zone Rep (CN-1, CN-2) within approximately 30 minutes of the record being created.

Board action For Portal submissions: no action is required — the record appears automatically in the Complaints Manager. For verbal, email, or written complaints: log in to the Admin Portal, launch Proxy Complaint Submission, and lodge the complaint on the resident's behalf. The lodgement notifications (CN-1, CN-2) are sent automatically within approximately 30 minutes of the record being saved, regardless of which path was used.

→ *Notification: CN-1 (resident), CN-2 (Board, RC, Zone Rep). See Appendix A.*

3.2 Acknowledgement and Deadline Alerts

The Board must formally acknowledge the complaint within 2 business days of receipt. On acknowledgement, the system sends the resident an acknowledgement notification (CN-3).

Board action Acknowledge either by clicking the acknowledgement link included directly in the CN-2 lodgement alert email (no Admin Portal login required), or by logging into the Admin Portal, opening the complaint in the Complaints Manager, and clicking Acknowledge. Either path sends CN-3 to the resident and updates the status to Acknowledged.

→ *Notification: CN-3 (resident). See Appendix A.*

The system checks for overdue deadlines every 4 hours and sends alerts to the Board and RC (not to the resident) at the following points. Each alert repeats every 24 hours for as long as the underlying condition persists — the Board and RC continue to receive reminders until the outstanding action is taken:

- 48 hours — if the complaint has not been acknowledged (CN-D1)

- 72 hours — if the complaint has been acknowledged but the Initial Determination has not yet been sent (CN-D2). This check is suppressed while the complaint is still Open — it only begins once the 48-hour acknowledgement step is complete.
- 28 days — if the complaint has not yet reached a closed status (CN-D3). This is an internal safety-net check, not a resident-facing deadline.

See Appendix A for full details.

3.3 Status Review and Initial Determination (Legislative Requirement)

Within 72 hours of receipt, the Board must review the complaint's status. This satisfies the Act's requirement for a written record of the reasons a matter remains unresolved and the actions proposed to resolve it.

- ***If the matter has already been resolved***, the Board selects Resolved at Status Review and proceeds directly to closure (Section 3.5) — the complaint's status remains Acknowledged until the closure is finalised; no Initial Determination is required.
- ***If the matter is not yet resolved***, the Board opens the Initial Determination panel.

Board action In the Complaints Manager, open the complaint and use the Status Review screen. If resolved, select Resolved and proceed to closure. If not resolved, select Not Resolved — Open Initial Determination. Use Save Only to draft and revise the Initial Determination freely. When ready, click Save & Send to Resident — this locks the Initial Determination permanently, sends it to the resident (CN-4), and updates the status to Responded. Any further Board commentary after this point must be recorded using Add Event.

→ *Notification: CN-4 (resident) — content is the Initial Determination. See Appendix A.*

3.4 Escalation

Escalation occurs when the resident refers the matter to VicAssist or another external body. This is the resident's right and does not require the Board's agreement, and can happen at more than one point in the process — most commonly during the 14-day window following a Non-Resolution Notice (Section 3.5), but also after a Resolved closure if the resident remains

dissatisfied. When the Board is notified of an external referral, it should record this in the Complaints Manager.

Board action In the Complaints Manager, record the escalation details (external body name, date of referral) and update the status to Escalated. The system sends an internal alert to Board, RC, and Zone Rep (CN-5) and a notice to the resident (CN-6).

→ *Notification: CN-5 (Board, RC, Zone Rep), CN-6 (resident). See Appendix A.*

3.5 Closure

A complaint reaches closure in one of several ways:

- Resolved or Partially Resolved — the matter is resolved, in full or in part, at any point in the process, including at Status Review (quick path) or after the Initial Determination.
- No Further Action — if the Initial Determination does not resolve the matter, the Board issues a Non-Resolution Notice, giving the resident an explicit 14-day window (with a calculated expiry date) to notify the Board of an intention to escalate. This sets the status to Closure - Pending. If the resident does not notify the Board within the 14 days, the system automatically closes the complaint as No Further Action and sends a formal closure notice — no manual Board action is required to close it.
- Resolved (Escalated), Unresolved (Escalated), or Unresolved (External Resolution Failed) — if the resident does notify the Board of an intention to escalate (Section 3.4), the Board records the outcome once the external process concludes: Resolved (Escalated) if resolved through conciliation; Unresolved (Escalated) if the matter proceeded to VCAT (or another forum) without resolution through conciliation; or Unresolved (External Resolution Failed) if the process ended because one party refused to participate or the matter was deemed unsuitable for conciliation.
- Converted to Dispute — the complaint has been reclassified as a neighbourhood dispute and the dispute record opened (this is handled automatically — see Section 4.1).

On any closure, the system sends an internal status alert to the Board, RC, and Zone Rep (CN-7) and a closure notification to the resident (CN-8).

Board action In the Complaints Manager, open the complaint record and select the appropriate closure outcome, completing the closure narrative for Resolved, Partially Resolved, or the relevant Escalated outcome. Click Close

Complaint. No action is needed for the automatic 14-day No Further Action closure — the system handles this on its own.

→ *Notification: CN-7 (Board, RC, Zone Rep), CN-8 (resident). See Appendix A.*

3.6 Complaint Status Reference

Status	Meaning
Open	Complaint received. Acknowledgement pending.
Acknowledged	Formally acknowledged. Status Review due within 72 hours.
Status Review	Momentary review point at the 72-hour mark — resolves immediately into either the quick-resolution closure path or Responded.
Responded	Initial Determination sent to resident. Matter may proceed to closure, or if unresolved, to a Non-Resolution Notice.
Closure - Pending	Non-Resolution Notice issued. Resident has a 14-day window to notify an intention to escalate.
Escalated	Resident has notified an intention to escalate, or referred the matter externally. Board continues to cooperate and maintain the record.
Closed - Resolved	Resolved. Closure notice issued to resident.
Closed - Partially Resolved	Resolved in part. Closure notice issued to resident.
Closed - No Further Action	The 14-day window passed without the resident notifying an intention to escalate. Closed automatically; formal closure notice issued.
Closed - Resolved (Escalated)	Resolved following conciliation with VicAssist.
Closed - Unresolved (Escalated)	Matter proceeded to VCAT (or another forum) without resolution through conciliation.
Closed - Unresolved (External Resolution Failed)	Conciliation ended because one party refused to participate, or the matter was deemed unsuitable for conciliation.
Closed - Converted to Dispute	Reclassified as a neighbourhood dispute. Dispute record opened automatically. See Section 4.1.

Closed - Unresolved (legacy)	Legacy outcome retained on older records only — no longer settable on new complaints.
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4. Disputes — Operator Procedure

4.1 Conversion from Complaint to Dispute

Where the Board determines that a complaint is more appropriately dealt with as a neighbourhood dispute between residents, the complaint can be converted at any point up until it is closed — misclassification is not always apparent at lodgement (a complaint framed as a maintenance or parking issue can turn out, on investigation, to be a dispute between two specific residents). Convert to Dispute is available from three panels: Status Review (Acknowledged), the Initial Determination screen (Status Review — Not Resolved), and Close This Complaint (Responded). This process is initiated by the Board — residents do not request conversion directly.

Board action In the Complaints Manager, open the complaint and click Convert to Dispute (available on the Status Review, Initial Determination, or Close This Complaint panel, depending on the complaint's current stage). The Disputes Manager opens automatically, pre-filled with Party A's details. Complete the dispute record: Party B's details, Issue Detail (a fresh, Board-authored, tactfully-worded description sent to both parties), and optionally Category and Incident Date/Time. The original complaint's own description is shown for reference only while drafting Issue Detail — it is not sent to either party. Save the record. On saving, the system automatically closes the complaint record with the status 'Closed — Converted to Dispute' and records this in the System Log. The original complainant (Party A) receives a notification referencing their original complaint and explaining that the matter has been converted to a dispute (CN-8 Converted variant). The dispute party registration notices (DN-1) are then sent to both parties within approximately 30 minutes.

→ *Notification: CN-8 Converted variant (Party A — references original complaint). DN-1 (both parties, within 30 minutes). See Appendix A.*

The original complainant's own account (from the Description field of their original complaint) is automatically recorded as a Party A Event in the new dispute record, visible to the Board in the Party A Events pane. This preserves the original account as context for the Board without it being

reused as the Issue Detail sent to both parties — the resident's original wording may not be appropriately toned for the other party to read verbatim. This is an internal record only; no separate notification is sent to Party A about it.

4.2 Operator-Initiated Disputes

Where the Board becomes aware of a matter affecting residents' quiet enjoyment without a formal complaint having been lodged, the Board may create a dispute record directly in the Disputes Manager without a preceding complaint. The Operator has an obligation to act on matters affecting quiet enjoyment regardless of whether a formal complaint has been received.

Residents who are reluctant to be identified as the party who raised a concern — a common and understandable position in a small community — should be assured that the Operator will take reasonable steps to protect their identity consistent with the requirements of the Act.

4.3 Registration

On creating a dispute record (whether from complaint conversion or Operator-initiated), the system sends party registration notices (DN-1) to both parties and an internal alert to the Board and RC (DN-2) within approximately 30 minutes. Each party receives a separate, individually addressed notification. Issue Detail — a single, Board-authored, tactfully-worded description — is what is sent to both parties; it also serves as the internal record.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, create the dispute record. Enter both parties' details and Issue Detail. Category and Incident Date/Time may optionally be recorded for reporting purposes. Save the record. The party registration notices (DN-1) and Board/RC alert (DN-2) are sent automatically within approximately 30 minutes.

→ *Notification: DN-1 (Party A and Party B, separate), DN-2 (Board, RC). See Appendix A.*

4.4 Acknowledgement and Deadline Alerts

The Board must formally acknowledge the dispute within 2 business days of it being registered. On acknowledgement, the system sends both parties an acknowledgement notification confirming the matter is being considered.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, open the dispute record and click Acknowledge Dispute. This sends the acknowledgement notification to both parties and updates the status to Acknowledged.

→ *Notification: Acknowledgement notice (Party A and Party B). See Appendix A.*

The system runs automated deadline checks and sends alerts to the Board and RC (not to the parties) at the following points. Unlike the equivalent Complaints alerts, these repeat every 24 hours for as long as the underlying condition persists, rather than firing once — a dispute that is never actioned will continue to generate reminders rather than going silent:

- While the dispute remains Open (not yet acknowledged), starting 2 business days after registration
- While the dispute is Acknowledged with no Process Statement recorded, starting 72 hours after registration
- While the dispute remains unresolved past its 28-day review deadline (see Section 4.8)

See Appendix A for full details.

4.5 Status Review: Resolved or Process Statement

Once acknowledged, the Board decides whether the matter is already resolved or requires the formal Process Statement / mediation process. This decision point exists so that a dispute resolved very quickly — for example, a brief misunderstanding cleared up in a short conversation — does not require the full Process Statement step. Where a dispute is resolved within 72 hours of being registered, the Management System automatically records this as a quick resolution for reporting purposes; no additional Board action is required to flag it as such.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, on an Acknowledged dispute, select either: (a) Resolved — Proceed to Closure, which opens the Resolution Summary field directly (see Section 4.7); or (b) Not Resolved — Open Process Statement, which opens the Process Statement field (see Section 4.6). This selection is not itself a status change or a notification — it determines which of the two subsequent actions is available.

4.6 Process Statement

Where a dispute is not resolved quickly, the Operator issues a Process Statement to both parties setting out the proposed approach to facilitating

resolution. The Operator acts as impartial mediator and does not determine who is right or wrong. This satisfies the legislative requirement to record a written action plan if the matter is not resolved within 72 hours of notice being given (Section 1).

Board action In the Disputes Manager, from the Status Review screen, select Not Resolved — Open Process Statement. Draft the Process Statement and click Send Process Statement & Notify Both Parties. This sends the Process Statement notification to both parties and updates the status to Under Review. A dispute cannot reach Under Review without a Process Statement having been recorded.

→ *Notification: Process Statement notice (Party A and Party B). See Appendix A.*

During the mediation process, all significant activity should be recorded using the Add Event function in the Disputes Manager. Events should include meetings, phone calls, correspondence received and sent, inspections, and Board assessments. Each event includes a visibility setting: Board-only (internal) or party-visible (included in party correspondence records). See Section 9 for detail on the Correspondence Record capability.

4.7 Resolution

A dispute may be resolved either quickly, directly from the Status Review screen without a Process Statement (Section 4.5), or following the standard mediation process once Under Review (Section 4.6). Both paths lead to the same Resolved status and the same notification to both parties.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, record the Resolution Summary and click Mark Resolved & Notify Both Parties. The system sends the resolution notice to both parties and updates the status to Resolved.

→ *Notification: Resolution notice (Party A and Party B). See Appendix A.*

4.8 External Referral — 28-Day Obligation

If the dispute is not resolved within 28 days of notice being given, the Operator must refer the matter to an appropriate external body. VicAssist Retirement Villages is the primary referral pathway under the Act. Both parties are notified of the referral.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, on a dispute Under Review, select the Referring Organisation (VicAssist Retirement Villages, or Other with the

organisation specified), record the reasons for referral, and click Refer to External Body & Notify Both Parties. This sends the referral notice to both parties, naming the actual referring organisation, and updates the status to Referred to External Body.

→ *Notification: External referral notice (Party A and Party B). See Appendix A.*

4.9 Closure of Referred Disputes

Once the external body's process has concluded, the Board records the outcome and closes the dispute. The Board selects a Closure Reason from a fixed list, reflecting how the matter concluded — the file is closed regardless of which of these outcomes applies; the Board's obligation is to see the referral through to its conclusion, whatever that conclusion is, not to guarantee a particular result.

Closure Reason	Meaning
Resolved via VicAssist Conciliation	Both parties reached agreement through the conciliation process.
Proceeded to VCAT (or other forum)	The matter moved beyond VicAssist to a further forum. This is now the resident's own matter, conducted outside the Management System.
Terminated — one party refused to participate	The conciliation process could not proceed because one party declined to take part.
Terminated — matter unsuitable for conciliation	VicAssist determined the matter was not appropriate for its conciliation process.

Board action In the Disputes Manager, on a dispute Referred to External Body, select the Closure Reason and optionally add further notes, then click Record Outcome & Close Dispute. This sends the closure notice to both parties, naming the closure reason, and updates the status to Closed — Referred.

→ *Notification: Closure notice (Party A and Party B). See Appendix A.*

4.10 Dispute Status Reference

Status	Meaning
Open	Dispute registered. Party notifications pending (sent within approximately 30 minutes). Acknowledgement pending.

Acknowledged	Formally acknowledged. Board deciding whether resolved or requires a Process Statement. 28-day period running.
Under Review	Process Statement issued. Board actively mediating. 28-day period running.
Resolved	Dispute resolved (either quickly from Acknowledged, or following mediation from Under Review). Resolution notice issued to both parties.
Referred to External Body	Not resolved within 28 days. Referred to VicAssist or other external body. Board cooperating.
Closed — Resolved	Resolution confirmed and record closed.
Closed — Referred	External body's process concluded. Closure reason recorded. Record closed.

5. Annual Reporting

The Board maintains a complete register of all complaints and disputes in the Management System. At each annual meeting, the Board presents a report, generated from the Management System, covering the number and nature of complaints and disputes and their outcomes. The report does not identify individual parties; any commentary on process improvements is for the Board to add separately when presenting. Within 14 days of the annual meeting, the Board provides a copy of the dispute report to the Director of Consumer Affairs Victoria via myCAV.

6. Privacy and Records

Information about a complaint or dispute is handled with discretion. It is not disclosed to persons beyond those involved in its resolution, except as required by law. All records are retained in the Management System for a minimum of 7 years. Reports presented at the annual meeting do not identify any individual resident or party.

7. Matters Outside This Procedure

This procedure does not apply to: emergencies (call 000); matters the subject of current legal proceedings or VCAT applications; matters relating to termination of a residency agreement. The Operator reserves the right to decline to progress a complaint or dispute that is determined, acting

reasonably, to be frivolous, vexatious, or made in bad faith. The resident will be advised in writing with reasons.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

Party	Responsibilities
Operator (Board of Management)	Establishes and maintains this policy. Nominates contact persons. Receives, records, and manages all complaints and disputes. Issues acknowledgements, Initial Determinations, and closure notices within required timeframes. Records all significant activity via Add Event. Refers unresolved disputes to VicAssist at 28 days. Presents annual report.
Primary Contact Person	Receives and records all complaints and disputes in the first instance. Records complaints lodged verbally, by email, or in writing via Proxy Complaint Submission; manages resolution of records created either way. Triggers notifications at each stage. Keeps residents and parties informed.
Alternative Contact Person	Steps in when the Primary is unavailable, involved in the matter, or not empowered to deal with it. Holds a senior position. Not a relative or friend of the Primary.
System Administration	Maintains and supports the Management System (Admin Portal, Resident Portal, Zone Rep Portal). Not responsible for the management of individual complaints or disputes.
Residents	May raise a complaint at any time, verbally or via the Resident Portal, without adverse consequence. May be represented by another person. Expected to engage in good faith.
Zone Representatives	Monitor complaint timelines in their zone via the Zone Rep Portal. Raise overdue matters with the Residents Committee Chairperson. No decision-making role in individual complaints or disputes.

9. Events and Correspondence Record

Add Event

The Add Event function is available in both the Complaints Manager and the Disputes Manager. It allows the Board to record structured events against any complaint or dispute — meetings, phone calls, correspondence received or sent, inspections, assessments, and status or resolution updates. Each event records a timestamp, the Board member's name, event type, a summary, and a visibility setting: for complaints, Resident and/or Board; for disputes, Party A, Party B, and/or Board — any combination may be selected.

Correspondence Chronicle

The Correspondence Chronicle generates a filtered correspondence report for any complaint or dispute, drawing together system events and Board-recorded events into a single document. Four versions are available: Board Record (complete, confidential); Resident Copy (complaints only — redacted, omits Board Comments, Board Log emails, inbound replies, and internal notes); and, for disputes, separate Party A Copy and Party B Copy versions, each showing only that party's own events and notes plus any notes marked as shared — the other party's details are not included. Accessible to Board members with the Complaints-Manager role via the Admin Portal.

10. External Pathways Reference

Body	Role	Contact
VicAssist Retirement Villages	Free government conciliation service for retirement village matters.	vic.gov.au/retirement-village-dispute-help
Consumer Affairs Victoria	Regulatory body. Information, advice, compliance and enforcement.	consumer.vic.gov.au 1300 55 81 81
Victorian Civil and Administrative Tribunal (VCAT)	Formal hearing process for disputes not resolved by conciliation.	vcat.vic.gov.au
Independent Legal Advice	Law Institute of Victoria or Victoria Legal Aid for legal support.	liv.asn.au legalaids.vic.gov.au

11. Document Control and Review

This policy is reviewed annually or earlier if required by changes to legislation, the Code of Practice, or village circumstances. The Board consults with residents before making material changes.

Document Title	Complaints and Disputes — Board and Operator Guide
Version	V1.2
Issue Date	July 2026

Next Review	June 2027
Legislative Basis	Retirement Villages Act 2024 (Vic), effective 1 May 2026
Supersedes	V2.7 (July 2026) — combined document, split into the Resident Guide and this Board and Operator Guide
Pending action	Resolved by the V1.0 split — the Resident Guide (formerly Part 1 of this document) is now a standalone document provided directly to residents.
V1.0 change summary	This Board and Operator Guide split out as a standalone document from the combined Complaints and Disputes Policy V2.7. Sections renumbered: old Sections 6–16 → new Sections 1–11; Appendix A unchanged. The resident-facing procedure (old Sections 1–5) is now published separately as the Complaints and Disputes — Resident Guide V1.0. Historical change-summary entries below predate the split and refer to the old combined-document section numbers unless noted otherwise.
V1.1 change summary	"Residential Club" corrected to "Residential Village" throughout. Section 3 (Complaints — Operator Procedure) substantially rewritten to match the live ComplaintsManager code: 3.1 corrected to describe Proxy Complaint Submission as the only path for non-electronic lodgement (previously described a non-existent manual entry function; Proxy form confirmed to have no declaration field); 3.2 added the email-link acknowledgement path and corrected deadline-check cadence; 3.3 renamed "72-Hour Action Plan" to "Status Review and Initial Determination" to match actual terminology; old 3.4 "Board Response — within 28 days" removed as it no longer describes a real step (superseded by the 72-hour Initial Determination); 3.5-3.6 (renumbered from 3.6-3.7) rewritten to include Closure - Pending, the 14-day auto-close to No Further Action, and the escalated-closure outcomes. ComplaintsManager backend updated to V3.0.40 in parallel: all three deadline alerts (48h/72h/28-day) now repeat every 24 hours, matching Disputes' existing behaviour — Section 3.2 and Appendix A.1 (CN-D1–D3) updated to match. Section 4.1 corrected: Convert to Dispute is available from three panels (Status Review, Initial Determination, Close This Complaint), not just at acknowledgement. All "Board action" boxes throughout Sections 3 and 4 converted from bordered tables to the no-border shaded style. Section 5 (Annual Reporting) corrected — the generated report does not include an automated "process improvements" narrative. Section 8 (Roles and Responsibilities) terminology updated to match Section 3 (Initial Determination, not "action plans/responses"; Primary Contact Person role description aligned with Proxy Complaint Submission). Section 9 corrected: Add Event visibility is multi-select (not a Board-only/party-visible binary); Correspondence Chronicle description corrected in V1.2 to reflect the module's actual four print versions, including separate Party A/Party B copies for disputes — V1.1 had incorrectly stated only two versions existed. Appendix A.1 substantially rewritten: CN-4 renamed "Board

	Response" → "Initial Determination"; CN-8 rewritten to cover all five real closure outcomes; new CN-9 (Non-Resolution Notice) and CN-10 (automatic No Further Action closure) added — both previously undocumented; CN-D1–D3 updated from "fires once" to the escalating 24-hour-repeat behaviour.
V1.2 change summary	Correspondence Chronicle description in Section 9 corrected to reflect the module's actual four print versions (Board Record, Resident Copy, and separate Party A/Party B copies for disputes) — V1.1 had incorrectly stated only two versions existed with no per-party split. The Resident Guide's Neighbourhood Disputes section and this Guide's Disputes — Operator Procedure section (old combined-document numbering: Section 4 and Section 9 respectively) were updated to reflect the Disputes Manager's Acknowledged status, Status Review decision point, Issue Detail field (replacing the earlier Nature of Dispute / party-facing description split), Category and Incident Date/Time fields, structured Referring Organisation and Closure Reason selections, and escalating (repeating) deadline alerts. Appendix A.2 updated to match — Acknowledgement notification and auto-alert rows added.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Chairperson			
Secretary			

APPENDIX A

Notification Reference

All notifications are sent from irc.mtceteam@gmail.com. This address does not accept replies. Complaint notifications to residents (CN-1, CN-3, CN-4, CN-6, CN-8) do not include Board direct contact details. CN-9 and CN-10 are exceptions — both include direct Board contact details, since they occur at points where the resident may need to reach the Board directly (the 14-day escalation window, and final closure). Dispute notifications to parties (DN-1 through DN-7) do include Board direct contact details.

A.1 Complaint Notifications

Ref	Stage	Trigger	Recipients	Content summary
CN-1	Lodgement — Resident	Record created (Portal: automatically on submission; Board-entered: on save). Sent within approximately 30 minutes.	Resident	Reference number; complaint summary (category, description, desired outcome, respond-by date); VicAssist and CAV details; do-not-reply notice.
CN-2	Lodgement — Internal	Same trigger and timing as CN-1.	Board (full details + acknowledge link); RC (courtesy copy); Zone Rep (unit, category, deadline)	Board: full complaint details including resident contact info, acknowledge link, Admin Portal link. RC: complaint details, no action link. Zone Rep: unit, category and deadline only.
CN-3	Acknowledgement	Board clicks Acknowledge in Complaints Manager, or clicks the acknowledgement link in the CN-2 email.	Resident	Acknowledgement confirmed; respond-by date; do-not-reply notice.

CN-4	Initial Determination	Board clicks Save & Send in Complaints Manager.	Resident	Full Initial Determination text; external pathways information; do-not-reply notice.
CN-5	Escalation — Internal	Board sets status to Escalated.	Board, RC, Zone Rep	Status change notice; escalation details; action to maintain and update record.
CN-6	Escalation — Resident	Board sets status to Escalated.	Resident	Escalation acknowledged; external body details; do-not-reply notice.
CN-7	Closure — Internal	Board closes complaint.	Board, RC, Zone Rep	Closure notice with outcome. Not sent for the automatic No Further Action closure — see CN-10.
CN-8	Closure — Resident	Board closes complaint with an outcome of Resolved, Partially Resolved, Resolved (Escalated), Unresolved (Escalated), Unresolved (External Resolution Failed), or Converted to Dispute.	Resident	Resolved / Partially Resolved: resolution summary. Resolved (Escalated): resolved through VicAssist conciliation. Unresolved (Escalated): matter proceeded to VCAT (or another forum) without resolution through conciliation. Unresolved (External Resolution Failed): conciliation ended because one party refused to participate, or the matter was deemed unsuitable for conciliation.

				Converted to Dispute: original complaint reference; reason for conversion; new DISP reference number. (Note: Party B receives standard dispute registration notice DN-1 — not CN-8.) Does not cover the automatic No Further Action closure — see CN-10.
CN-9	Closure - Pending — Non-Resolution Notice	Board sets status to Closure - Pending (matter not resolved after the Initial Determination).	Resident	Non-Resolution Notice; explicit 14-day expiry date to notify an intention to escalate; external pathways information; includes Board direct contact details; do-not-reply notice.
CN-10	Auto-Closure — No Further Action	System auto-closes 14 days after Closure - Pending with no escalation notified (automated scan). Not triggered by the Board.	Resident only — no internal copy is sent; Board, RC, and Zone Rep must monitor Closure - Pending records directly in the Complaints Manager.	Formal closure notice; outcome No Further Action; resident's ongoing external rights restated (VicAssist, VCAT, independent legal advice); includes Board direct contact details; do-not-reply notice.
CN-D1	Auto — Acknowledgement overdue	Complaint not acknowledged within 48 hours. Repeats every 24	Board, RC only	Acknowledgement overdue, with days-overdue count; action required. Not sent to resident.

		hours while unacknowledged.		
CN-D2	Auto — Initial Determination overdue	Complaint acknowledged but Initial Determination not sent within 72 hours. Repeats every 24 hours. Suppressed while still Open (covered by CN-D1 instead).	Board, RC only	Initial Determination overdue, with days-overdue count; action required. Not sent to resident.
CN-D3	Auto — 28-day safety net	Complaint has not reached a closed status within 28 days of lodgement. Repeats every 24 hours.	Board, RC only	28-day internal safety-net deadline passed, with days-overdue count; check current status and take outstanding action. Not sent to resident.

A.2 Dispute Notifications

Notifications DN-D1 through DN-D3 are escalating — they repeat every 24 hours for as long as the underlying condition persists, unlike the equivalent Complaints auto-alerts (CN-D1–D3), which fire once only. This was a deliberate change: a dispute alert that fires once and is missed previously went silent indefinitely; the repeating design ensures an unactioned dispute continues to be visible to the Board.

Ref	Stage	Trigger	Recipients	Content summary
DN-1	Registration — Parties	Approximately 30 minutes after dispute record is saved (automated trigger). Each party receives a separate notification.	Party A and Party B (individually addressed)	Reference number; Issue Detail; 28-day review period; Board direct contact details (email and phone); do-not-reply notice. No information about the other party is included in each individual notification.
DN-2	Registration — Internal	Approximately 30 minutes after dispute record is	Board, RC	Full dispute details including party names, contact information, Issue Detail, and Category if recorded;

		saved (same trigger as DN-1).		required action within 2 business days (Acknowledge Dispute).
DN-3	Acknowledgement	Board clicks Acknowledge Dispute in Disputes Manager.	Party A and Party B	Acknowledgement confirmed; 28-day review period; Board direct contact details.
DN-4	Process Statement	Board selects Not Resolved at Status Review and sends the Process Statement.	Party A and Party B	Process statement text; Under Review status; 28-day period; Board direct contact details.
DN-5	Resolution	Board marks dispute Resolved — either directly from Status Review (quick path) or following mediation from Under Review (standard path).	Party A and Party B	Dispute resolved; resolution summary; Board direct contact details.
DN-6	External Referral	Board selects Referring Organisation and records the referral.	Party A and Party B	Matter referred to the named organisation (VicAssist Retirement Villages, or Other as specified); reasons for referral; external body contact details; Board direct contact details.
DN-7	Closure	Board selects a Closure Reason and closes the dispute.	Party A and Party B	Dispute closed; closure reason; any additional notes recorded; Board direct contact details.
DN-D1	Auto — Acknowledgement overdue	Dispute not acknowledged within 2 business days of registration. Repeats every 24 hours while unacknowledged.	Board, RC only	Acknowledgement overdue, with days-overdue count; action required. Not sent to parties.
DN-D2	Auto — Process Statement overdue	Dispute Acknowledged but no Process Statement recorded within 72 hours of registration. Repeats every 24 hours. Suppressed while still Open (covered by DN-D1 instead).	Board, RC only	Process Statement overdue, with days-overdue count; action required. Not sent to parties.
DN-D3	Auto — 28-day referral overdue	28-day review deadline passed without resolution.	Board, RC only	External referral overdue, with days-overdue count;

		Repeats every 24 hours.		action required. Not sent to parties.
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Lake Illawong Residential Village — Board of Management — Complaints and Disputes — Board and Operator Guide V1.2